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NOBLEMAN
PRODUCTIONS

The screening room.

The Nobleman Productions client portal: how to use it, how to run it, how to take it live, and how to move it to noblemanproductions.com.

MANUAL · EDITION 2 OCTOBER 2026 FOR THE STUDIO AND ITS CLIENTS

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START HERE

Three things *to know*

Nobody reads a manual first, and the portal is built for that: every screen says what it's for and what to do next. These three cards are all most people ever need.

If you're a client

- 1 Open the email from the studio.
- 2 Press its button. You land on the right page.
- 3 Watch, pause to leave a note, then **Approve** or **Ask for changes**.

→ That's it. Home always shows your one next step.

If you're the studio

- 1 Open the portal's Home each morning.
- 2 Work down **Needs the studio**, top to bottom.
- 3 Glance at **Waiting on clients**; send a reminder if one is late.

→ Home is empty of work when nothing needs you.

If something's wrong

- 1 **Studio → Settings → System check.** Each row says what to fix.
- 2 Find what you see in chapter 10.
- 3 Still stuck: write to the help email in **Settings → Studio details**.

→ Nothing in the portal is lost by pressing the wrong button: anything hard to undo asks first.

The addresses

WHAT	BEFORE THE MOVE	AFTER THE MOVE (CHAPTER 8)
Website	noblemanproductions.gotit2work.com	noblemanproductions.com
Portal	portal.noblemanproductions.gotit2work.com	portal.noblemanproductions.com
Sample project	the portal's address + /demo	the same

Old addresses keep working after the move: the website forwards page for page, and the portal sends people on to its new address. Bookmarks and old emails never break.

How to read this manual

Buttons and places in the portal look **like this**, and paths read left to right:

Studio → Settings → Login screen. Numbered steps go in that order.

"You'll see"

After a step, → You'll see: says what should happen. If it doesn't, stop there and look up what you see in chapter 10, instead of carrying on.

• Chapter 01

The portal *at a glance*

One private place where clients watch every version, leave notes on the exact moment, approve, pay, and download, and where the studio runs every project.

One door for everyone

Clients, staff, and owners log in at the same page. Clients then see their own company's projects; staff also see **Studio**. Nobody picks a "client login" or a "staff login".

Simple for clients

A busy executive opens an email, presses one button, and approves a film. Home leads with one next step, and clients only ever see the newest version.

Run without code

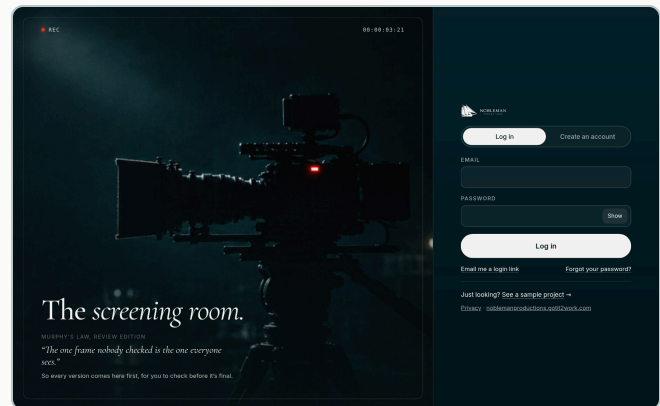
Wording, photos, stages, roles, connections, switches, and the portal's address are settings in Studio. Code changes only add or remove what the portal can do.

How a project moves

Set up	Review	Note	Decide	Pay	Deliver
Studio creates the project, picks where its videos come from, and invites the client.	A new version arrives; the client is emailed and watches it.	They pause anywhere and leave notes pinned to that moment.	They approve it, with small fixes if any, or ask for changes.	The studio asks for a payment; the client pays on Stripe.	Finished films to watch, download, caption, and share.

Words this manual uses

Version	A cut sent for review, numbered by its name: "Harbor Spot V2". Clients see only the newest.
Finished film	A video without a version number: delivered, in Films.
Decision maker	The client person who approves and pays. Reviewers leave notes; viewers watch.
Switch	What a project allows, such as downloads or uploads. Set per project in Studio.

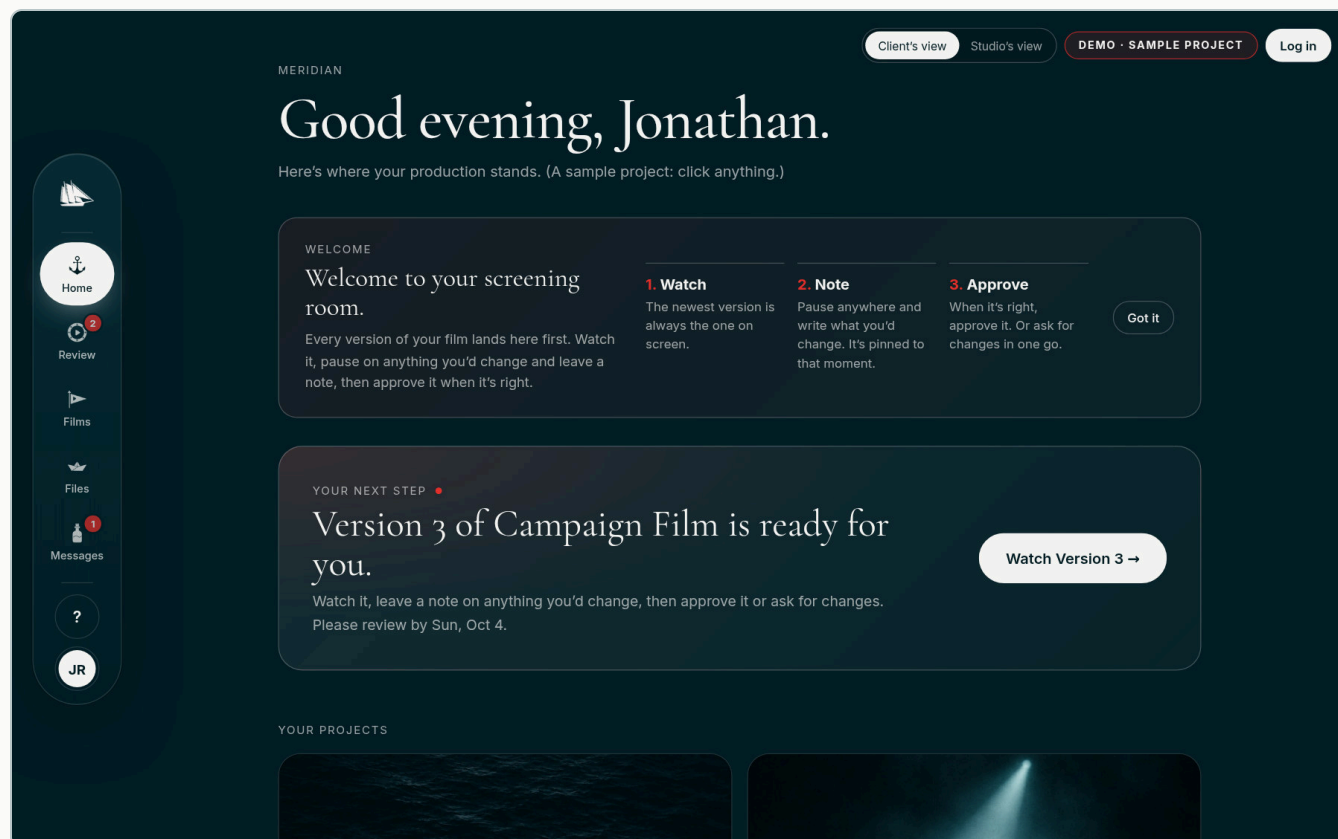


The login: one door, a short form, and the studio's Murphy's Law. The photo is chosen in Settings.

• Chapter 02

What *clients* see

Six places, each one tap away: Home, Review, Films, Files, Messages, and Payments. What appears depends on what the studio switched on for the project, and on the person's role.



Home for a client: the welcome on a first visit, then the one next step, the projects, and the latest activity.

Home: one next step

Home leads with the single thing that needs this person now, in this order: a version to review, a payment, a milestone to confirm (such as a filming day), a new message, a new film. When nothing needs them, it says so.

Project cards and pages

Each card shows the stage, what's next, and at most one flag (versions to review, else a new message). The project page has one tile each for Review, Films, Files, Payments, and Messages, with what's waiting: "2 waiting for you, by Sun, Oct 4".

Review: *one version, notes on the moment*

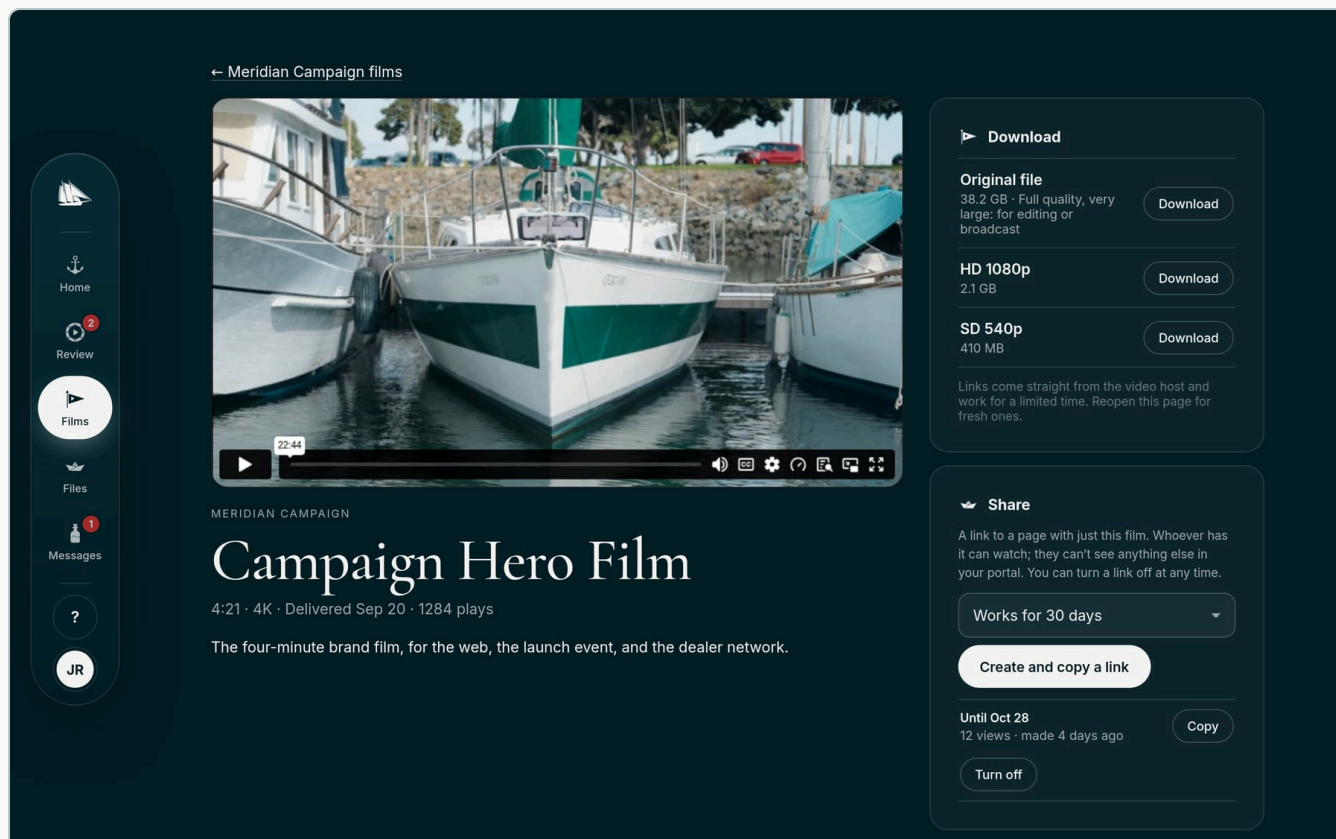
The screenshot shows a client portal interface for a 'MERIDIAN CAMPAIGN'. At the top, there are tabs for 'Client's view', 'Studio's view', and a highlighted 'DEMO · SAMPLE PROJECT' tab, along with a 'Log in' button. The main heading is 'Review Campaign Film'. Below it, a subtitle reads: 'Watch it, pause anywhere, and leave a note on that exact moment. When it's right, approve it.' There are two buttons: 'Campaign Film' and '15-Second Outdown'. A video player is shown with a 'PREVIEW · VERSION 3' label. The video shows a boat in a harbor. Below the video, it says 'Version 3' and 'The newest version. It replaces Version 2 and earlier.' with a timestamp '4:21 · shared Sep 28'. A note below the video says 'Opening reworked around the wide shot. Color adjusted on the water scenes.' At the bottom of the video player area, there are two buttons: 'Approve Version 3' and 'Ask for changes'. On the right side, there is a 'Notes on Version 3' section with 'All 3' and 'Open 2' buttons. It includes a text input field 'ADD A NOTE AT 0:00' with a placeholder 'What would you change at this moment?'. Below this, there are two notes from 'Jonathan Reyes' at 0:12 and 0:41. The 0:12 note says 'Can we hold this wide a beat longer before the cut?' and the 0:41 note says 'Love this shot.' Both have 'Reply' and 'Mark done' options. At the bottom of the notes section, there is a note from 'Justin' at 1:05 saying 'Thank you. That one took three passes to catch the light.' with 'Reply' and 'Mark done' options. On the left side of the interface, there is a vertical navigation menu with icons for Home, Review (highlighted), Films, Files, Messages, and a search icon.

Review: the newest version with its "Preview" mark, the notes beside it, and the decision under the player.

- **Only the newest version.** When Version 3 arrives, Version 2 disappears for the client: "The newest version. It replaces Version 2 and earlier." Staff open every version, one at a time. A project can show clients earlier versions too (the **Earlier versions** switch).
- **A preview mark.** Versions under review carry "Preview · Version N" on the player, so nobody mistakes a draft for the final film.
- **Notes on the moment.** Pause anywhere, write a note, and it's pinned to that second. Clicking its time jumps the film there. Staff reply under it and mark it done.
- **Decide in one place.** The box under the player says the date first ("Please decide by Sun, Oct 4."), then offers **Approve Version 3** or **Ask for changes**. Open notes go with a request for changes.
- **Approve, with small fixes.** Approving has an optional "Any small fixes?" box, so "yes, but lift the logo" needs no extra round. The studio is told; the client gets a receipt.
- **Who decides.** Decision makers approve; reviewers leave notes; viewers watch. Decision makers get one reminder before the date.

WHAT CLIENTS SEE · FILMS, FILES, MESSAGES

Finished films, *files*, and *a conversation*



A finished film: watch it, download it in the sizes the video host has ready, and create a link to share it.

Films

Finished films to watch and, where it's switched on, download (and the original full-quality file, if allowed), with caption files and chapters.

Share links send one film to someone outside the portal for 7, 30, or 90 days or until turned off, and count views.

Files

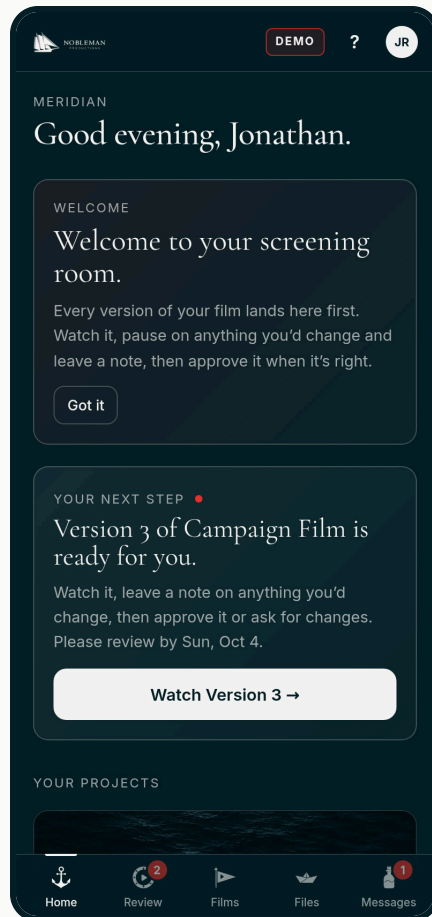
Documents from the studio (quotes, schedules, call sheets), and anything the client sends: logos, references, footage. Files up to 500 MB go to private storage; videos go straight to the project's Vimeo folder, up to 50 GB each.

Messages

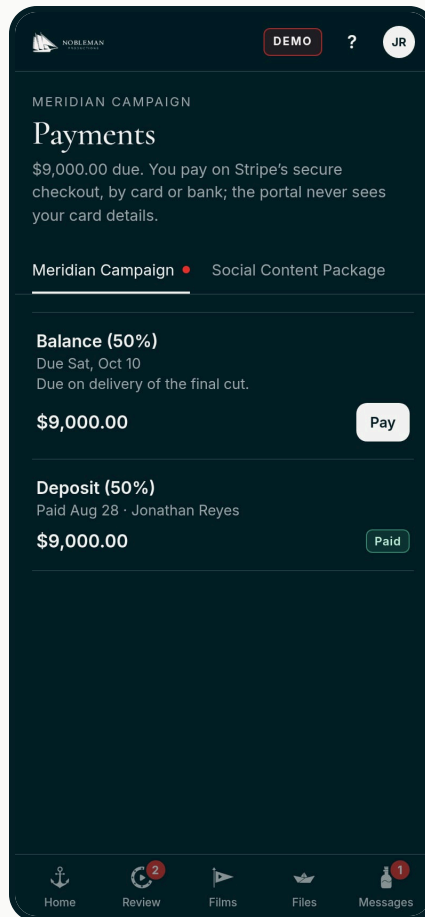
One conversation per project. A line above it says who they're writing to and when to expect a reply (set in Settings, promising only what's always true). Unread messages show as a badge.

Quiet email. Each email links straight to what it's about, nobody is emailed about their own actions, and nobody is emailed while they're using the portal (active in the last three minutes). Everyone can turn updates off under **Account**.

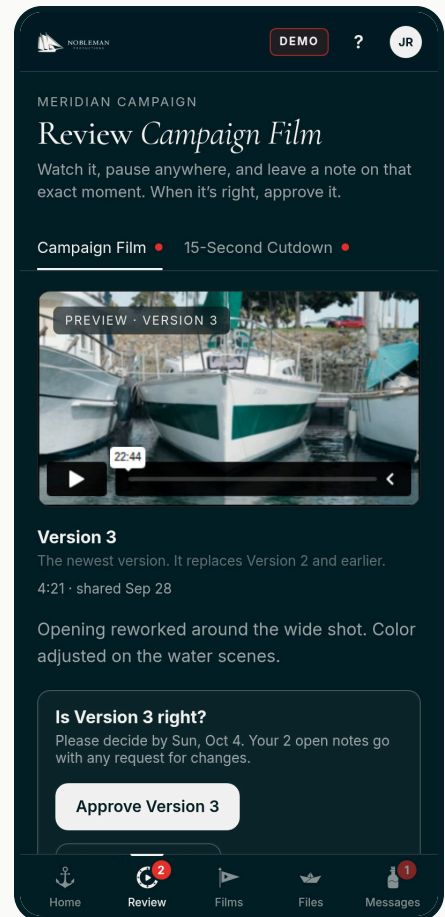
WHAT CLIENTS SEE · PAYMENTS, ACCOUNT, PHONE

Paying, their account, and on a phone

Home on a phone: a plain bar on top, tabs along the bottom.



Payments: what's due, what's paid, and one button to pay.



Review fits the phone: the player, the version, then the decision.

Payments

When the studio asks for a payment, Home says **Please pay** and the project shows what's due. **Pay** opens Stripe's secure checkout (card, plus whatever else is turned on in Stripe), so card details never reach the portal. Only decision makers pay; others see what's due.

Their own team

Decision makers invite colleagues (who get an emailed link), change their roles, and remove them.

What each role can do opens a short list. The studio is told each time.

Account

Name and job title, email updates on or off, and two-step verification with an authenticator app (with recovery codes, saved once). **Change my password** opens the form; changing it logs them out on other devices. A new email address goes through the studio.

Logging in

With a password, or an emailed login link (works once, within 15 minutes). **Forgot your password?** emails a link to choose a new one (works once, within an hour). New people can **Create an account** when the studio allows it.

• Chapter 03

Roles *and switches*

Two things decide what someone can do on a project: the project's switches, and their role. The server checks both on every action; hiding a button is never the only protection.

ROLE	KIND	BY DEFAULT
Owner	Staff	Everything, always, including settings, connections, roles, and staff. Keep at least two.
Producer	Staff	Clients, people, projects, and payments day to day; not connections, settings, staff, or deleting clients.
Editor	Staff	Adds versions and files, answers notes and messages, updates progress.
Decision maker	Client	Reviews, approves, downloads, shares, uploads, messages, pays, and manages their team.
Reviewer	Client	Watches and leaves notes. Can't approve or pay; sees what's due.
Viewer	Client	Watches and downloads. No notes or messages.

Owners change what Producers, Editors, and the client roles may do in **Studio → People → What roles can do**. Two permissions (manage staff; change settings and roles) are owner-only and can't be granted, so nobody can give themselves more than an owner gave them.

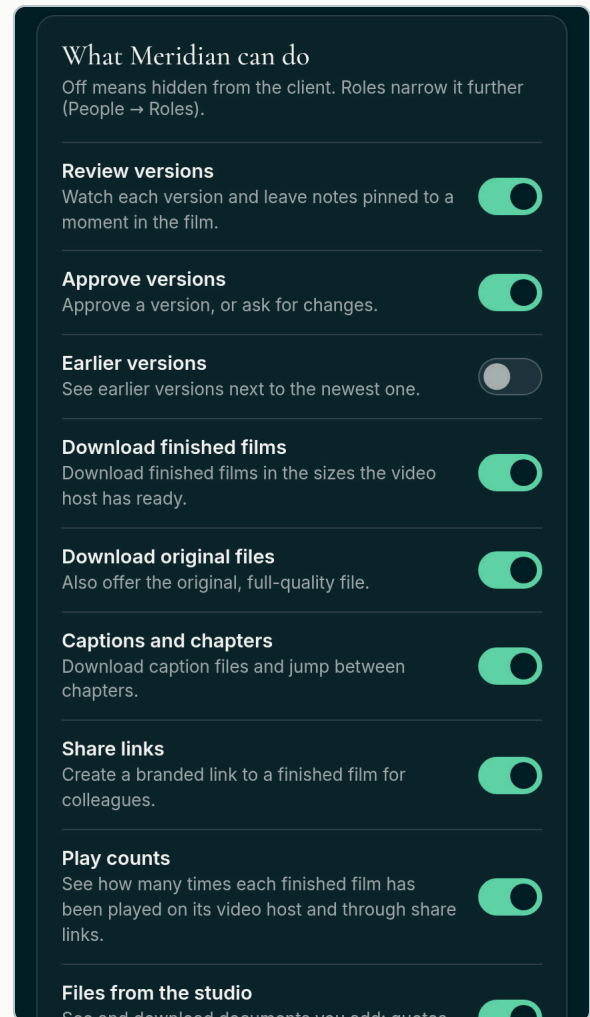
STAFF PERMISSION	OWNER	PRODUCER	EDITOR	CLIENT PERMISSION	DECISION MAKER	REVIEWER	VIEWER
Create and edit projects	●	●	–	Leave notes	●	●	–
Update progress	●	●	●	Approve or ask for changes	●	–	–
Manage videos and files	●	●	●	Download	●	●	●
Ask for and record payments	●	●	–	Share links	●	–	–
Clients and their people	●	●	–	Send files	●	●	–
Export data, activity log	●	●	–	Messages	●	●	–
Connections	●	–	–	Pay	●	–	–
Staff, settings, roles	●	–	–	Manage their team	●	–	–

ROLES AND SWITCHES · PROJECT SWITCHES

What each project *allows*

Every project has its own switches, in **Studio → Projects → a project → What they can do**. New projects start from **Settings → New projects start with**. Off means hidden from the client and refused by the portal. Staff can always do everything.

SWITCH	STARTS	WHAT THE CLIENT GETS
Review versions	On	Watch each version and leave notes on a moment.
Approve versions	On	Approve, or ask for changes. Needs Review.
Earlier versions	Off	Open earlier versions too, one at a time.
Download finished films	On	The sizes the video host has ready.
Download original files	Off	Also the full-quality original. Very large.
Captions and chapters	On	Caption files and chapter jumps.
Share links	Off	A page for one finished film, for colleagues.
Play counts	Off	Plays at the host and through share links.
Files from the studio	On	Quotes, schedules, call sheets.
Uploads	Off	Send files, and video to the Vimeo folder.
Messages	On	A conversation with the studio.
Payments	On	See and pay what the studio asks for.
Downloads after payment	Off	Downloads open once everything is paid.



The switches on a project (here on a phone), each with one line saying what it does.

MURPHY'S LAW, DELIVERY EDITION

"The file you didn't lock is the one that leaves early."

So **Downloads after payment** holds final files until the balance is in, while the client can still watch everything.

• Chapter 04

Running *the studio*

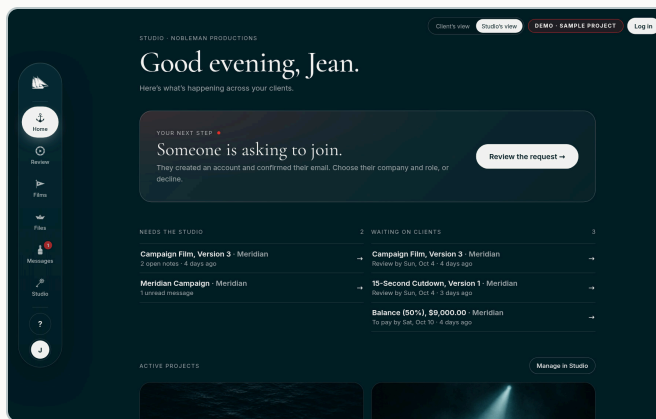
Studio is where staff run everything: projects, clients, people, connections, settings, and the activity log. Each tab and button appears only when the person's role allows it.

Staff Home

Leads with what needs the studio: people asking to join, changes a client asked for, unread messages, open notes. Below it, two lists: **Needs the studio** and **Waiting on clients** (versions to review and payments due), then active projects and the five latest things anyone did.

Getting started

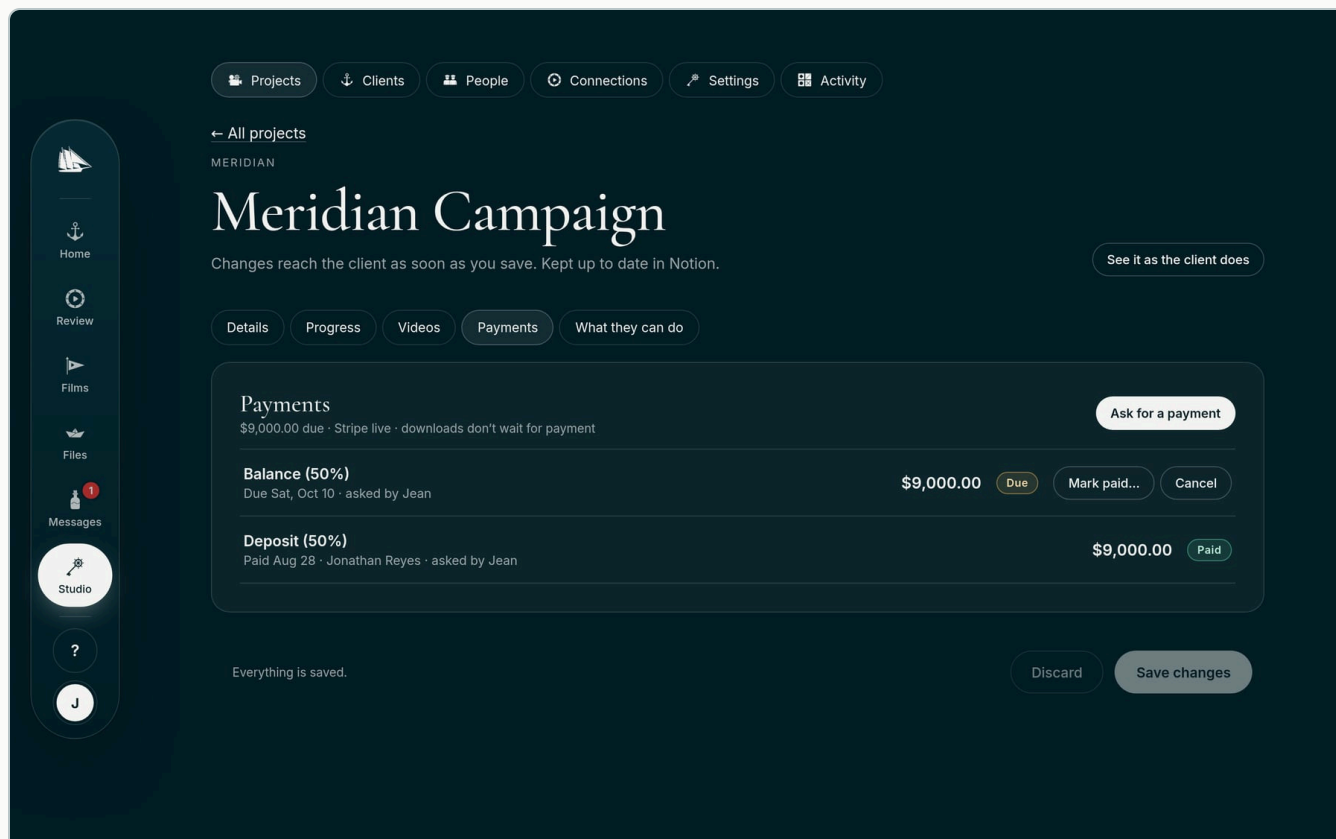
On a new, empty portal, owners see a checklist instead: file storage, email, a video source, the first client, the first project, the first invitation, plus Stripe, Notion, and a second owner as options. Each line links to where it's done, and the list goes away by itself.



The studio's Home in the demo: someone asking to join comes first.

TAB	WHO, BY DEFAULT	WHAT YOU DO THERE
Projects	All staff	Create projects; each opens in parts (Details, Progress, Videos, Payments, What they can do) under one Save. Export all projects to a spreadsheet.
Clients	Owners, producers	Companies: name, logo, private notes, email domains for joining. Export everything about a client (JSON). Delete.
People	Owners, producers	Let in or decline people asking to join; invite. Each person has Edit (role, company, email) and More : reset password or resend the invitation, log out everywhere, turn off two-step for a lost phone, remove. What roles can do has its own button.
Connections	Owners	Video sources, Notion, payments (Stripe), and email. Keys are stored encrypted and never shown again.
Settings	Owners	Nine short sections, one open at a time, beginning with the System check.
Activity	Owners, producers	Who did what and when. One Show menu (who, a client, or a project) and a search; export. Kept about 13 months.

A project, in five parts



A project in Studio, on its Payments part. **See it as the client does** opens the client's page.

Details

Name, kind of project, summary, client, and an optional cover image link (empty uses the newest film's thumbnail). **Archive** hides it from the client and can be undone; **Delete project...** removes its notes, decisions, messages, share links, payment records, and files for good, after typing its name. Videos stay where they are.

Videos

Where videos come from, and every video there. A title with a version number ("Harbor Spot V2") goes to Review; the rest go to Films. Each film's earlier versions fold under its newest. Each video's **More** menu hides it, renames it for the client, or makes it a finished film; nothing changes at the source.

Progress

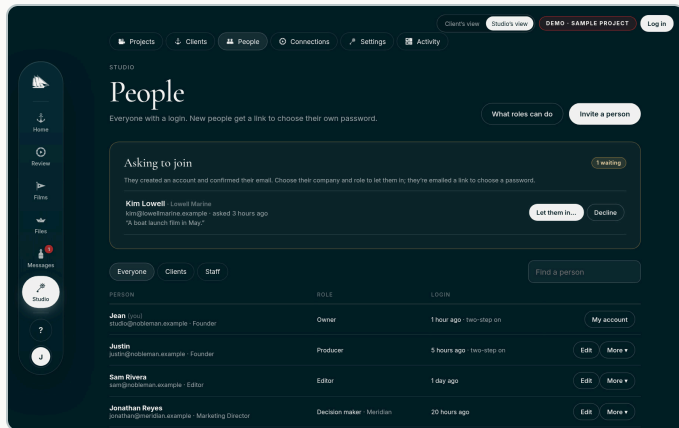
The stage (its progress shows by itself; type a number only to override it), the next milestone (label, date, what happens) with an option to ask the client to confirm it, the review-by date, and **Email a review reminder now**.

Payments, and what they can do

Ask for a payment, cancel one, or **Mark paid...** for a check or wire (chapter 6). The last part holds the project's switches (chapter 3).

RUNNING THE STUDIO · PEOPLE AND SETTINGS

People, settings, *and the system check*



People: requests to join on top, then everyone with their role and last login.

Settings, one section at a time

System check Everything the portal needs, with what to do about anything that isn't right.

Studio details Name, help email, the portal's address (the website and privacy page follow it), the line above Messages.

Login screen The photo (one of the studio's or an upload), which side stays in view, and the Murphy's Law.

Welcome message Shown once, on a client's first visit.

Notice for everyone One line at the top of every page.

Project stages Names, order, and the progress each shows.

New projects start with The default switches.

Logins and accounts Two-step for staff, login links, client teams, who can create an account, joining by domain, how long logins last.

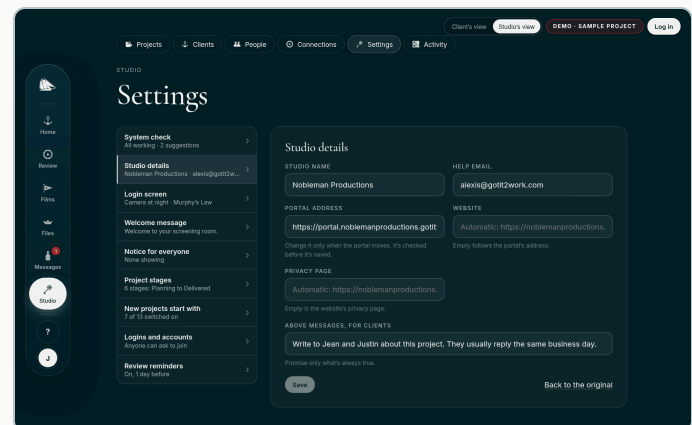
Review reminders On or off, and how many days before the date.

Invitations, never passwords

Nobody sets or sees another person's password. An invitation or reset is a one-time link (invitations last 14 days), emailed and also shown to copy. A newer link replaces older ones.

Asking to join

When sign-up is on, anyone can create an account; it waits until the studio lets them in, choosing their company and role. People whose email domain is listed on a client join that client as soon as they confirm their email.



Settings → Studio details: the portal's address leads; the website and privacy page say "Automatic" and follow it (chapter 8).

• Chapter 05

Connections

The accounts the portal works with, each added in **Studio → Connections**, tested with one button, and stored encrypted. Nothing here needs a developer.

Video sources

A project's videos come from one place: a folder (or playlist, or project) in a connected account, or video links pasted one by one. In every source, a title with a version number becomes a version: "Harbor Spot V2", "Harbor Spot - Version 4", "Harbor Spot (V5)".

SOURCE	PLAYS IN	VERSIONS	DOWNLOADS	CAPTIONS	UPLOADS
Vimeo	Vimeo's player	By name	Standard plan and up (else "Download on Vimeo")	●	●
Frame.io	The portal's player	Version stacks	Original and smaller copies	–	–
YouTube	Privacy-enhanced player	By name	None	–	–
Wistia	The portal's player	By name	Yes	●	–
Video links	The link's own player	By name	None	–	–

Vimeo

Jean, in Vimeo: developer.vimeo.com → **Create an app** → **Generate an access token** → Authenticated (you), scopes **Public, Private, Edit, Upload, Video Files, Stats**. Paste it in Studio; **Test it** ticks each scope. Each project uses one folder. Videos must allow embedding (Unlisted or Hide from Vimeo; embed Anywhere or the portal's address).

Frame.io, YouTube, Wistia, links

Frame.io signs in through Adobe (Studio shows the redirect address to copy); version stacks are versions. **YouTube**: a Data API key; one playlist per project. **Wistia**: an API token; one project each. **Video links** need no account: paste YouTube, Vimeo, Google Drive, Loom, Wistia, Dropbox, or .mp4 links.

CONNECTIONS · TRACKING, EMAIL, FILES, PAYMENTS

Notion, email, *files*, and Stripe



Notion

One row per project, kept up to date within seconds: name, client, stage, progress, review status, latest version, open notes, next step, review-by date, last activity, and a link back. Create an internal connection (Read, Update, Insert content), paste its token, add the connection to the Notion page, then let Studio create the database or use yours. The card keeps **Sync now** and **Test it** in view; the rest is under More. No names, emails, notes, or messages go to Notion.



Email (Resend)

Invitations, account confirmations, login and reset links, updates, approval receipts, review reminders, and payment emails. A Resend API key with sending access on the verified `gotit2work.com` domain, sending as `portal@gotit2work.com`. **Send a test email** checks it end to end. Without email, links are shown in Studio to copy.



File storage

Documents and client files in a private Vercel Blob store: nothing has a public address. Uploads go straight from the browser to storage; downloads use links that expire after ten minutes. Set up in Vercel, not in Studio (chapter 7).



Payments (Stripe)

The secret key (test or live), the currency, and the webhook signing secret. Until the webhook is connected, the card shows its address (with a Copy button) and the four events to choose in Stripe; after that, they fold under **Show the setup**. Test mode first, then live (chapter 7, step 12).

Studio → Connections in the demo: each card shows whether it's working, when it was checked, and what to change.

• Chapter 06

Payments

The studio asks; the client pays on Stripe's own checkout; the portal marks it paid only when Stripe says so. Card and bank details never touch the portal.

Ask Studio → a project → Payments → Ask for a payment : what for, amount, due date, note.	Tell Decision makers are emailed a link; Home says Please pay .	Pay Stripe's checkout: card, or another way turned on in Stripe.	Confirm Stripe's signed webhook, the return from checkout, or the daily job.	Paid The studio is emailed; anything held opens.
--	--	--	--	--

What each status means

Due	Asked for, not paid yet. Shows a due date if one was set.
On its way	A bank payment (ACH) was made and is clearing, usually a few business days. If it fails, it goes back to Due and both sides are told.
Paid	Stripe confirmed it, or the studio recorded a check or wire with Mark paid...
Refunded	Refunded in full in Stripe.

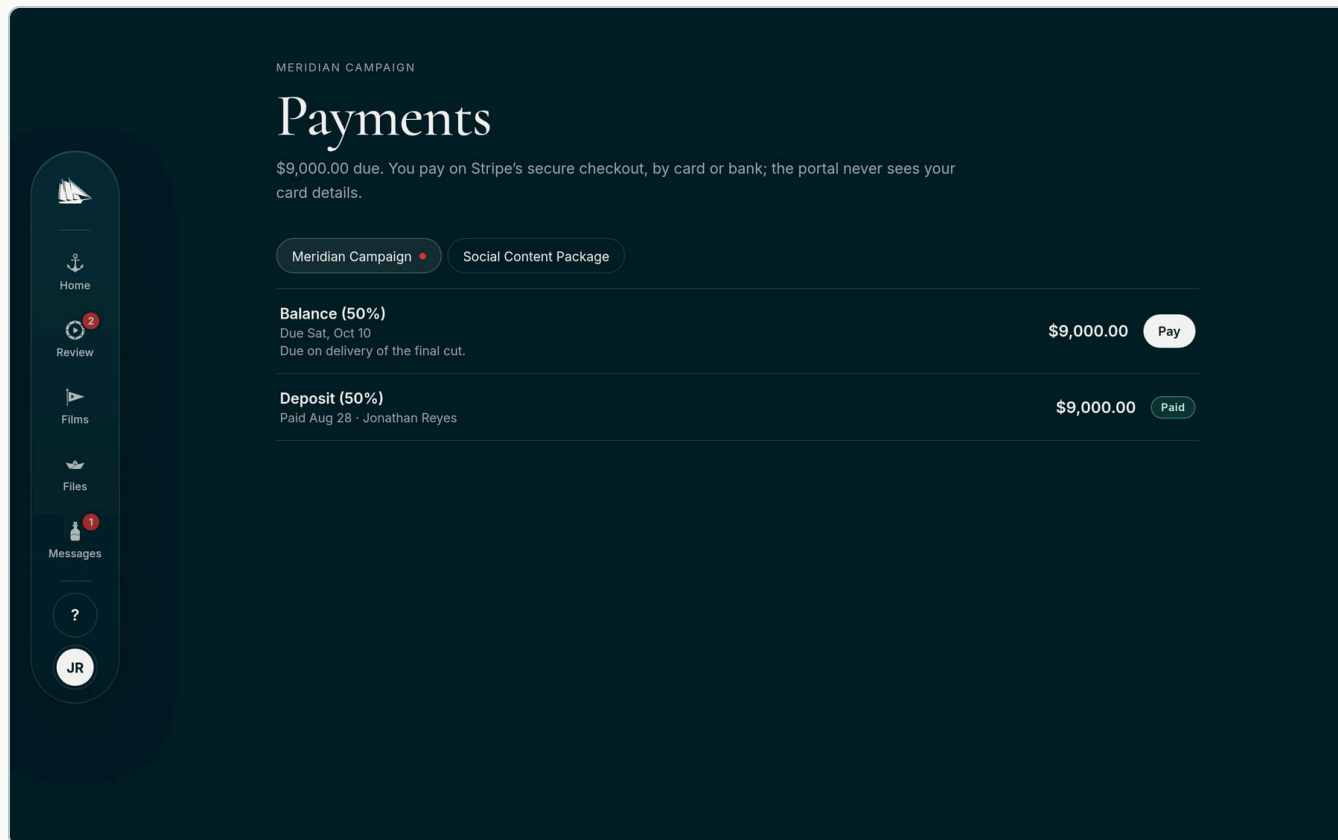
Canceling an unpaid request removes it for the client and stops its checkout, so it can't be paid any more.

Why it can be trusted

- "Paid" only ever comes from Stripe, never from the browser.
- The webhook is checked against its signing secret and refused if it's more than five minutes old.
- The amount and currency must match what was asked for.
- A payment moves to paid once, so nobody is emailed twice, however often Stripe retries.
- Pressing Pay twice reuses the same checkout: no double charge.
- If the client closes the page and the webhook is missed, the daily job asks Stripe.

Fees and payouts are Stripe's: see your Stripe dashboard and Stripe's pricing page. Turn on **Successful payments** under Stripe → Settings → Customer emails so clients get Stripe's receipt.

PAYMENTS · BOTH SIDES

What the client sees, *and who does what*

The client's Payments page: the balance due with Pay, the deposit marked paid with who paid and when.

Downloads after payment

A project switch (off unless you turn it on). While anything asked for on the project is unpaid, finished films can be watched but not downloaded; the download card says so and links to what's due. Staff are never held. Once it's paid, by Stripe or **Mark paid...**, downloads open at once.

Who can do what

Decision makers pay. **Reviewers and viewers** see what's due. **Owners and producers** ask, cancel, and mark paid. **Owners** connect Stripe. Each request, cancellation, payment, and refund is in the activity log, and every client data export includes the payment records.

• Chapter 07

Going live

From the public sample to the real, empty portal, then every connection.
Settings in Vercel, Stripe, and Studio only: no code, and no help needed.
About 90 minutes for steps 1 to 11; Stripe takes longer the first time, while it reviews the new account.

Before you start

- ☐ **Vercel Pro.** Hobby is for non-commercial use; a portal that bills clients is commercial. Team Gotit2Work → Settings → Billing.
- ☐ Vercel access to **nobleman-portal** in team Gotit2Work.
- ☐ A password manager open, for five secrets.
- ☐ A terminal on your own computer.
- ☐ Later: Jean for the Vimeo token; GoDaddy for email records; the Stripe login.

The path

PART	STEPS	WHERE	WHAT YOU END WITH
A. The empty portal	1 to 8	Vercel	The login at the portal's address, your owner account, and two-step verification.
B. Connections	9 to 12	Resend, Vimeo, Notion, Stripe, then Studio → Connections	Email, videos, project tracking, and payments, each tested.
C. People and projects	13 and 14	Studio	Real clients, projects, and invitations; the login screen and settings.

The full runbook, with every field and what to expect after each step, is `docs/GO-LIVE.md` in the portal's repository. These pages are the same steps, shortened.

Secrets stay with you. Generate them on your own computer, save each one in the password manager, and never paste them into chat, email, or a document. Mac: `openssl rand -base64 48`. Windows (PowerShell 7):
`[Convert]::ToBase64String([System.Security.Cryptography.RandomNumberGenerator]::GetBytes(48))`

Three things you'll repeat

Add a variable: Vercel → nobleman-portal → Settings → Environment Variables → Add New. Tick Production and Preview, turn on **Sensitive**, Save.

Redeploy: Deployments → the newest Production one → ... → Redeploy. Wait for Ready.

Check: open `.../api/session`. It answers in plain text; each step says what to look for.

Vercel: database, storage, *secrets*, *first owner*

- 1 **Database.** Vercel → nobleman-portal → Storage → **Create Database** → **Neon**; region Washington, D.C. (iad1); name `nobleman-portal-db`; connect to Production and Preview. Expected: `DATABASE_URL` appears. No SQL to run; the portal makes its own tables.
- 2 **File storage.** Storage → **Create** → **Blob**, access **Private**, name `nobleman-portal-files`, connect to Production and Preview. Expected: `BLOB_READ_WRITE_TOKEN` appears.
- 3 **Secrets.** Add four, each Sensitive, Production and Preview:

KEY	WHAT IT'S FOR	AFTER SETUP
<code>SESSION_SECRET</code>	Signs logins. Changing it logs everyone out.	Keep
<code>PORTAL_ENCRYPTION_KEY</code>	Encrypts the keys pasted into Studio. Never change it once connections exist.	Keep
<code>CRON_SECRET</code>	Lets Vercel run the daily job.	Keep
<code>BOOTSTRAP_SECRET</code>	The one-time setup code for the first owner.	Delete
- 4 **Turn off the sample at the front door.** Delete `PORTAL_MODE`. The sample stays at `/demo`.
- 5 **Redeploy.** Expected: `/api/session` shows `"demoAtRoot":false`, `"db":true`, `"setup":true`, `"setupReady":true`; the address shows **Set up the portal**.
- 6 **First owner.** Enter the `BOOTSTRAP_SECRET` value as the setup code, your name, email, and a password of 10+ characters → **Create the owner account**. Home shows Getting started. Setup only works while no staff account exists.
- 7 **Remove the setup code.** Delete `BOOTSTRAP_SECRET` → redeploy. System check → Setup code: "Removed after setup".
- 8 **Two-step for yourself.** Account → **Set up two-step verification**; save the recovery codes in the password manager.

Screenshots for your records: Environment Variables before step 1, and the System check after step 8.

Email, Vimeo, Notion, *and Stripe*

- 9 **Email.** resend.com → Domains: gotit2work.com should already be **Verified** for the website's form (if not, do the website runbook's Phase 5 first; its records never change the root SPF, the Microsoft 365 MX, or the apex). API Keys → Create: name "Nobleman portal", **Sending access.** Studio → Connections → **Connect email:** the key; send from Nobleman Productions <portal@gotit2work.com>; replies to the address Jean and Justin read. Expected: Send a test email arrives.
- 10 **Vimeo (Jean).** developer.vimeo.com → Create an app → Generate an access token (Authenticated, scopes Public, Private, Edit, Upload, Video Files, Stats). Studio → Connections → Add a connection → Vimeo. Expected: Test it ticks each scope.
- 11 **Notion (optional).** Create an internal connection (Read, Update, Insert content) → paste its token in **Connect Notion** → in Notion, add the connection to the page → in Studio, create the database or use yours. Expected: "Projects sync to ...".
- 12 **Stripe.**
 - a. **The account** (Jean or Justin): sign up, activate payments (business details, payout bank, statement name). Settings → Branding: logo, #031e25, #e5322d. Customer emails: Successful payments on. Payment methods: cards on; ACH Direct Debit if clients pay large balances by bank.
 - b. **Test mode:** Developers → API keys → Secret key (sk_test_...) → Studio → Connections → Payments → **Connect Stripe**, currency `usd`. Expected: "Test mode" and the account name.
 - c. **Webhook:** copy the address from the Stripe card (.../api/connect?webhook=stripe) → Stripe → Developers → Webhooks → Add endpoint → events `checkout.session.completed`, `checkout.session.async_payment_succeeded`, `checkout.session.async_payment_failed`, `charge.refunded` → reveal the signing secret (whsec_...) → Studio → Change → paste. Expected: Webhook: Connected.
 - d. **Full test:** ask a test client for \$1 → pay with card 4242 4242 4242 4242, any future date, any CVC. Expected: "Thank you. \$1.00 is paid.", Paid in Studio, the payment in Stripe, an email to the studio.
 - e. **Live:** turn off test mode; repeat b and c with the live key and the live endpoint's own secret; pay a real \$1 and refund it. Expected: Refunded.

People and projects, *then check it all*

- 13 People and projects.** Studio → People: invite Jean and Justin as Owner or Producer (at least two owners). Studio → Clients: add each company, with its email domain if its people may join by themselves. Studio → Projects → **New project**: the client, the Vimeo folder, then What they can do (Payments on; Downloads after payment if final files wait for the balance). Invite the client's decision maker.
- 14 Settings.** Studio details, Login screen, Welcome message, Review reminders. Once every staff member has two-step verification, turn on **Two-step verification for staff**.

Check it worked

- ☐ The invitation email arrives; its link sets a password.
- ☐ Home shows the next step; a version plays; a note on a moment saves.
- ☐ Approve with a small fix; the studio gets the receipt.
- ☐ A message and a small file go both ways.
- ☐ A test payment goes through; Downloads after payment holds downloads until it's paid.
- ☐ Studio → Activity lists each step; System check is all working.

Done when the address shows the login, the System check is all working, a test client could review, approve, message, upload, and pay, and the test client and project are deleted.

Rolling back

- **The sample at the front door again:** add `PORTAL_MODE = demo` and redeploy. Nothing in the database is touched; delete it again to return.
- **A bad deployment:** Deployments → the previous good one → ... → **Promote to Production**. The database only ever gains tables and columns, so an earlier version runs safely.
- **Payments:** remove the Stripe connection. Pay disappears at once; payment records stay; nothing is refunded or canceled in Stripe.

If something goes wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
The address still shows the sample	<code>PORTAL_MODE</code> is still set, or there was no redeploy.
"The portal is still being set up"	No database: step 1, then redeploy.
"Setup is switched off"	Add <code>BOOTSTRAP_SECRET</code> , redeploy, reload.
A connection says Not working	Change → paste a fresh key → Test it.
A payment stays Due after paying	Set up the webhook (12c) with the secret from the same mode as the key. The return and the daily job also catch it.
Every connection stopped working	<code>PORTAL_ENCRYPTION_KEY</code> changed: put the old value back, or re-enter each key.

• Chapter 08

Moving to *noblemanproductions.com*

The website and the portal move to the studio's own domain, without breaking a link, an email, a payment, or the studio's Gmail. About 45 minutes, plus waiting for DNS.

The rule that makes it safe

Every old address keeps working the whole time, so **nothing breaks if a step is late, skipped, or done out of order.**

- The old website address forwards to the new one, page for page.
- The old portal address keeps answering, and sends visitors on once the new one works.
- Stripe and Adobe keep reaching the old address until updated.
- The portal won't switch to an address that doesn't answer yet.

Before you start

- ☐ Jean and Justin agree to retire the current site (on Lovable); rollback brings it back in minutes.
- ☐ Access to the GoDaddy account with noblemanproductions.com, and to Vercel.
- ☐ A screenshot of that domain's DNS table, before any change.

Never touch the `MX` records (the studio's Gmail), the `google-site-verification` `TXT`, or anything named `send` or `_domainkey`.

#	DO	WHERE	YOU'LL SEE
1	Add the new addresses	Vercel → each project → Settings → Domains (keep the old ones)	Three domains, each with the record it wants
2	Point the domain at Vercel	GoDaddy → noblemanproductions.com → DNS (next page)	Vercel: Valid Configuration
3	Check the new addresses	A private browser window	Padlocks; the site, the portal; Gmail still works
4	Tell Vimeo, if asked	Vimeo → the video → Privacy → embed domains	The hero video plays
5	Change the code's addresses	<code>node scripts/move-domain.mjs --apply</code> in each repository, then push	"Done: ... now say noblemanproductions.com"
6	Forward the old website	Vercel → nobleman-website → old domain → Redirect to (not the portal's)	Old links open the new site
7	Confirm the portal's address	Studio → Settings → Studio details → Portal address	System check: two green rows
8	Update outside services	Stripe webhook, Adobe redirect URI, Notion, Google	Stripe's test event answers 200
9	Send email from the new domain	Resend, then Studio → Connections → Email (optional)	A test email arrives
10	Retire the old site, a week later	Lovable → unpublish	Nothing changes for visitors

Three records, *one switch*

The full guide, with every check, is `docs/MOVE.md` in the website's repository. These are the parts that need care.

Step 2: GoDaddy → `noblemanproductions.com` → DNS

DO	TYPE	NAME	VALUE
Edit	A	@	The A value Vercel shows (replaces <code>185.158.133.1</code> , the current site)
Delete	A	<code>www</code>	The current site's <code>185.158.133.1</code>
Add	CNAME	<code>www</code>	The CNAME value Vercel shows for <code>www</code>
Add	CNAME	<code>portal</code>	The CNAME value Vercel shows for the portal

Use Vercel's values exactly. Delete any other A record for @, and remove GoDaddy Forwarding if it's on. Leave every MX and TXT record as it is.

Step 7: the portal's own switch

- 1 Log in as an owner → **Studio → Settings → Studio details.**
→ You'll see: Portal address, Website, and Privacy page.
- 2 If Portal address isn't `https://portal.noblemanproductions.com`, type it → **Save.**
→ You'll see: Saved. If the address doesn't answer yet, nothing changes and the message says what to fix.
- 3 Leave Website and Privacy page empty: they follow the portal.
- 4 **Settings → System check.**
→ You'll see: Portal address, and Website and privacy page, both green.

Before go-live (the sample at the front door) there's nothing to do here: step 5 changed it. After the move everyone logs in once more, because a login belongs to an address.

If something goes wrong

Email stopped arriving	An MX record changed. Put back what the "before" screenshot shows.
Still "Invalid" after an hour	Compare GoDaddy with Vercel letter by letter; delete extra A records; turn off Forwarding.
The hero video shows a still	Step 4: Vimeo's embed list.
The portal won't save the address	It isn't answering as this portal yet: check steps 1 and 2.

The way back

Nothing in the move deletes anything. The site: put GoDaddy's @ and `www` back to `185.158.133.1`. The portal: set Portal address back to the old one (it answers, so it saves). The code: `git revert` the move commit. Both addresses work either way.

• Chapter 09

Everyday *playbooks*

The jobs that come up every week. Do each step, check what you see, and stop at the first surprise: chapter 10 says what it means.

Start a new client project

- 1 Studio → Clients → **Add a client**: name, email domain.
 - 2 Make a folder for it in Vimeo.
 - 3 Studio → Projects → **New project**: client, folder, switches.
→ You'll see: the project, with its five parts.
 - 4 Progress: the stage and the next milestone.
 - 5 Studio → People → **Invite a person**: the decision maker.
→ You'll see: the link, also emailed.
 - 6 Payments → **Ask for a payment**: the deposit.
- Done when the client's Home shows the project and the deposit (**See it as the client does**).

Final delivery and payment

- 1 Upload the final without a version number: it goes to Films.
 - 2 What they can do: **Downloads after payment** on.
 - 3 Payments → **Ask for a payment**: the balance.
→ You'll see: Due, and the client is emailed.
 - 4 Progress: stage Delivered.
- Done when the balance shows Paid and the client's downloads open by themselves.

Deliver a new version

- 1 Upload it to the project's Vimeo folder, named with its number: "Harbor Spot V3".
 - 2 Studio → the project → Videos → **Refresh from the source**.
→ You'll see: Version 3 at the top, newest.
 - 3 Optional: a review-by date under Progress.
- Done when the client is emailed and their Home says "Version 3 ... is ready for you". Their notes arrive on your Home under Needs the studio.

Someone can't log in

- 1 Studio → People → find them.
 - 2 More → **Reset password** (or **Resend invite** if they never logged in).
→ You'll see: the link, emailed and shown to copy.
 - 3 Lost phone with two-step on: More → **Turn off two-step**, after confirming it's really them.
- Done when their last login updates.

People, the login, *and the weekly check*

Add a staff member

- 1 Studio → People → **Invite a person**: Staff, Producer or Editor.
- 2 They choose a password from the email, then set up two-step.
- 3 Change **What roles can do** only if needed.

Done when they see Studio with the tabs their role allows.

Offboard a client

- 1 Studio → Clients → **Export data**; keep the file.
- 2 Archive each project (hidden, can be undone), or delete it.
- 3 Remove their people, or delete the client (its projects and files go too).

Done when their people can't log in and the export is filed.

Change the login photo or words

- 1 Studio → Settings → **Login screen**.
- 2 Choose a photo (or **Upload a photo**) and the side that stays in view; edit the Murphy's Law.
→ You'll see: the preview change as you go.
- 3 **Save**.

Done when a private window shows the new login.

The weekly check

- 1 Studio → Settings → **System check**.
→ You'll see: every row green, or what to do for the others.
- 2 Home → **Waiting on clients**: send a reminder for anything late.
- 3 Studio → Activity, if something looks odd.

Done when nothing is red and nothing has waited too long.

• Chapter 10

If something goes *wrong*

Find what you see, then do what it says. Start with the System check (Studio → Settings): it checks most of these for you.

FOR CLIENTS, AND THE STUDIO HELPING THEM

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"I didn't get the email"	Check spam. Then the studio: People → More → Resend invite or Reset password ; the link is also shown to copy and send by hand.
"The link has expired"	Links work once: invitations for 14 days, login links for 15 minutes, resets for an hour. Ask for a new one, or press Forgot your password? .
"I can't log in"	Forgot your password? on the login. If two-step is on and the phone is lost: a recovery code, or the studio turns it off (People → More).
The video won't play	Reload, or try another browser. The studio: the video's embed settings in Vimeo must allow the portal's address.
There's no Approve button	Only decision makers approve: ask yours. Or the project's Approve switch is off (Studio → the project → What they can do).
Download is missing or held	The project's download switch is off, or Downloads after payment holds it until everything is paid; Payments shows what's due.
There's no Pay button	Only decision makers pay. If nobody sees it, Stripe isn't connected (System check → Payments).

What you see, *and what to do*

WHAT YOU SEE

WHAT TO DO

A red or amber row in the System check	Each row says what to fix and where. Fix the red ones first.
A new version doesn't show up	Its name needs the number ("Title V3"). Then the project → Videos → Refresh from the source . If it says "still processing", wait for Vimeo.
A client paid, but it still says Due	Wait a minute and reload: Stripe confirms it. If it stays: System check → Payments (the webhook). The daily job also asks Stripe. Paid by check or wire: Mark paid....
Emails aren't going out	Studio → Connections → Email → Send a test email . If it fails, the card says why; Resend's domain must be verified.
A connection says Not working	The card → Change → paste a fresh key → Test it .
Every connection stopped at once	<code>PORTAL_ENCRYPTION_KEY</code> changed in Vercel: put the old value back, or re-enter each key.
Notion stopped updating	Connections → Notion → Sync now ; if that fails, Test it and check the database is still shared with the connection.
"The portal is still being set up"	No database yet: chapter 7, step 1, then redeploy.
The address still shows the sample	<code>PORTAL_MODE</code> is still set in Vercel, or there was no redeploy after deleting it.
Someone lands on an old address	That's fine: the portal sends them on to its address once that answers. System check → Portal address shows which one leads.
A button seems to do nothing	Look for the message at the bottom of the screen. In the demo, nothing is saved: it says so.
Something isn't on this list	Studio → Activity shows who did what and when. Then write to the help email in Studio details, with a screenshot.

MURPHY'S LAW, SUPPORT EDITION

"The problem disappears the moment you show someone."

So take the screenshot first, then ask.

• Chapter 11

Security *and* privacy

What protects clients' films, accounts, and money, and what the portal keeps. The full notice is the website's privacy page, linked from every page of the portal.

- **Logins.** Passwords are stored only as bcrypt hashes; nobody, staff included, can read them. Logins last 7 days by default (1 to 30 in Settings). A password, role, or email change, or Log out everywhere, ends every other session at once.
- **Two-step verification** with an authenticator app and ten single-use recovery codes. Owners can require it for staff.
- **Throttling.** Repeated wrong passwords, codes, or link requests from one email or one address are slowed down.
- **Scoping.** Clients only ever reach their own company's active projects. Every action is checked on the server against the project's switches and the person's role.
- **Stored keys** (Vimeo, Resend, Notion, Stripe) are encrypted (AES-256-GCM) and never sent to the page or shown again.
- **Files** are in private storage; downloads use links that expire after ten minutes.
- **One-time links** and share links are stored only as hashes. Share links can expire and be turned off, and show one film with nothing about the client.
- **Payments** happen on Stripe; the portal keeps the request, its status, who paid, and Stripe's reference numbers.
- **The activity log** keeps who did what for about 13 months.

The daily job runs at 14:17 UTC (early morning in San Diego and Las Vegas): it sends due review reminders, keeps Frame.io's sign-in fresh, catches Notion up, asks Stripe about open payments, and deletes old records (the activity log after about 13 months, used links after a week).

APPENDIX A

The Nobleman *document format*

The studio's documents (manuals, proposals, call sheets, delivery notes) share the website's look, so a client recognizes Nobleman on every page. This manual is built to it.

Type

Cormorant Garamond

Headlines, 500 weight; one or two words in italic 400 for emphasis ("The *screening room*"). Chapter titles 38 pt, section titles 20 pt.

Inter

Everything you read: 9.4 pt on 1.5 line spacing, 600 for emphasis. Labels in capitals, 7 pt, spaced 0.16 em. Codes and addresses in a monospace.

Page

US Letter, 0.75 in side margins. A running header (the ship mark, the document's name, the section) and a footer with the page number in Cormorant. The cover, the back, and each chapter's photo band are deep sea; reading pages are paper.

Color

Deep sea #031E25 covers, bands	Deck #0F3B47 labels, icons	Paper #FAFAF8 reading pages	Ink #0B2A31 text
Signal red #E5322D needs attention	Sea glass #2F8F6C done, working	Tint #EEF3F3 notes	Line #D6DFE0 rules, borders

Rules

- One red accent per spread, for what needs attention (the REC light, a step number, a warning).
- Numbers only for real sequences: steps, chapters.
- At most one Murphy's Law line per section, never where precision matters (prices, privacy, legal): the risk, then how we handle it.
- Real photos from Nobleman's work, never stock; the logo is never redrawn.
- Words follow the studio's writing guide: plain words, buttons named for what they do, no promise that isn't always true.

Making a new document. Copy `docs/manual/` in the portal's repository (this page's styles and fonts), replace the pages, and run `node docs/manual/build.mjs`. It prints the PDF and refuses any page whose content doesn't fit.

MURPHY'S LAW, THE LAST ONE

“Anything that can go wrong in the edit will show up in the final cut.”

So it shows up here first, where it can still be fixed.



Veteran owned · San Diego and Las Vegas
noblemanproductions.com

The client portal is operated
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